

Day 93 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (7): Special Intensive Revision Phase-III & ECINET

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision Phase-III rollout and its new unified digital platform, ECINET — extending the already-covered Supreme Court ruling on SIR's legality.

Q: What is Special Intensive Revision (SIR) Phase-III, announced in May 2026?

A: A phased revision of electoral rolls across 16 states and 3 Union Territories, aimed at ensuring electoral roll accuracy — removing deceased, permanently-shifted, duplicate, and non-citizen voters, while ensuring eligible citizens are not left out.

Q: Name a few of the 16 states covered under SIR Phase-III.

A: Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Odisha, Punjab, Telangana, Uttarakhand (among others — 16 states total).

Q: Which 3 Union Territories are covered under SIR Phase-III?

A: National Capital Territory of Delhi, Chandigarh, and Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

Q: What is ECINET, and what does it consolidate?

A: A unified digital platform from the Election Commission of India that consolidates over 40 previously separate apps/websites used for election-related tasks — part of ECI's broader digital reform push since February 2025.

Q: How does this connect to the Supreme Court ruling already covered (Day 82's a4-current-affairs-5 topic)?

A: That ruling (Association for Democratic Reforms v. ECI, May 2026) upheld the constitutionality of SIR for Bihar's electoral rolls specifically — SIR Phase-III is the nationwide ROLLOUT of the same broad SIR mechanism to 16 more states and 3 UTs.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. SIR Phase-III, announced in May 2026, covers how many states and Union Territories?

A. 10 states, 2 UTs

B. 16 states, 3 UTs ✓

C. 20 states, 5 UTs

D. 12 states, 4 UTs

Explanation: 16 states and 3 Union Territories. [medium, web-research]

2. The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process primarily aims to:

A. Redraw constituency boundaries

B. Ensure electoral roll accuracy by removing ineligible entries ✓

C. Introduce electronic voting machines

D. Increase the number of polling booths

Explanation: Ensure electoral roll accuracy. [medium, web-research]

3. ECINET, the Election Commission's new digital platform, consolidates how many previously separate apps/websites?

A. Over 10

B. Over 20

C. Over 40 ✓

D. Over 100

Explanation: Over 40. [hard, web-research]

4. Which Union Territory is covered under SIR Phase-III?

A. Puducherry

B. NCT of Delhi ✓

C. Andaman & Nicobar Islands

D. Lakshadweep

Explanation: NCT of Delhi. [medium, web-research]

5. ECI's broader digital reform push (including ECINET) has been underway since:

A. February 2023

B. February 2024

C. February 2025 ✓

D. February 2026

Explanation: February 2025. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Dice

READING MATERIAL

Dice is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. Real exam evidence (explicitly tagged by source year, 2013-2025) shows two distinct shapes: opposite-face deduction from multiple cube views, and dice-throw probability.

Q: Foundational rule: On a standard die, what do opposite faces always sum to, and why does this matter for solving these puzzles?

A: Opposite faces always sum to 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4) on a STANDARD die — but TNPSC dice puzzles often use lettered or non-standard-numbered faces specifically to stop you from relying on this shortcut, forcing you to actually deduce relationships from the given views instead.

Q: Method — deducing an opposite face from adjacency information: If face 2 is adjacent to faces 3, 5, and 6, what must be true about face 1's relationship to face 4?

A: Since 2 is adjacent to 3, 5, and 6, those three faces can't be opposite 2 — leaving only 1 or 4 as 2's possible opposite. With four faces (3,5,6, and whichever of 1/4 is also adjacent) surrounding face 2, the remaining face must be its opposite, and separately, on a standard 6-face die, this kind of constraint typically forces 1 and 4 to be adjacent to each other (since they're not the 2-pair) — real exam answer: '1 is necessarily adjacent to 4.'

Q: Method — three views of a cube → find the opposite face: Three pictures of the same cube show different combinations of visible letters/numbers. How do you find what's opposite a given face?

A: A face that appears on multiple different views, each time paired with DIFFERENT other visible faces, helps you eliminate possibilities — any face that has been seen adjacent to your target face (in ANY view) cannot be its opposite. Whatever face is never seen adjacent to it across all views is the opposite face.

Q: Method — probability of a sum from two dice: What is the probability of getting a prime-number sum when throwing two dice?

A: Possible sums range 2-12 (36 total equally likely outcomes from 6×6). Prime sums possible: 2,3,5,7,11. Count outcomes for each: sum=2(1 way),3(2),5(4),7(6),11(2) = 15 outcomes. Probability = $15/36$.

Q: Method — basic single-die probability: What is the probability of throwing a number greater than 4 on a single die?

A: Numbers greater than 4 on a standard die: 5 and 6 — that's 2 out of 6 outcomes. Probability = $2/6 = 1/3$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On a standard die, the numbers on opposite faces always sum to:

- A. 6
- B. 7 ✓**
- C. 8
- D. 9

Explanation: 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4). [easy, authored]

2. What is the probability of getting a sum of 7 when two dice are thrown?

- A. $1/12$
- B. $1/9$
- C. $1/6$ ✓**
- D. $1/4$

Explanation: 6 ways to make 7 out of 36 total outcomes: $6/36=1/6$. [medium, authored]

3. What is the probability of throwing an odd number on a single die?

- A. $1/6$
- B. $1/3$
- C. $1/2$ ✓**
- D. $2/3$

Explanation: Odd numbers (1,3,5) = 3 of 6 outcomes = $1/2$. [easy, authored]

4. If face 1 is adjacent to faces 2, 3, 4, and 5 on a die, which face must be opposite face 1?

- A. 2
- B. 3
- C. 4

D. 6 ✓

Explanation: Since 2,3,4,5 are all adjacent to 1, the only remaining face (6) must be opposite it. [medium, authored]

5. What is the probability of getting a sum greater than 10 when two dice are thrown?

A. $1/36$

B. $1/12$ ✓

C. $1/9$

D. $1/6$

Explanation: Sums >10 means 11 (2 ways) or 12 (1 way) = 3 outcomes out of 36 = $1/12$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Special Hero" — Christine M. Kerschan

READING MATERIAL

A poem dedicated to the poet's father, calling him her 'special hero' for his love and protection. Real coaching-site evidence tests figure-of-speech identification per line — and uniquely among the poems covered so far, several DIFFERENT devices appear across just 6 short lines, so precision matters more than pattern-guessing here.

Q: What is "Special Hero" about?

A: The poet's tribute to her father — recalling how he held her as a baby, gave her love and protection, and reflecting on how lucky she feels that he was 'chosen' to be her father.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "There is something special about a father's love."

A: Metaphor.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Seems it was sent to me from someplace up above."

A: Hyperbole — an exaggerated, larger-than-literal claim (the love being literally 'sent from above') used for emotional emphasis, not meant literally.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "How did I get so lucky, you were the dad chosen for me?"

A: Rhetorical question — asked for emotional effect, not expecting a literal answer.

Q: What figure of speech is the repetition of "I just wanted you to know"?

A: Anaphora — repetition of the same phrase at the start of successive lines.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Our love is everlasting."

A: Hyperbole — an absolute, exaggerated claim ('everlasting') used to emphasize depth of feeling.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Special Hero" is dedicated to whom, and written by whom?

A. Dedicated to a friend, by Sarojini Naidu

B. Dedicated to her father, by Christine M. Kerschan ✓

C. Dedicated to a teacher, by David Bates

D. Dedicated to a soldier, by Edgar Albert Guest

Explanation: Dedicated to the poet's father, written by Christine M. Kerschan. [easy, web-research]

2. Identify the figure of speech: "There is something special about a father's love."

A. Simile

B. Metaphor ✓

C. Personification

D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Metaphor. [medium, web-research]

3. Identify the figure of speech: "Seems it was sent to me from someplace up above."

A. Anaphora

B. Alliteration

C. Hyperbole ✓

D. Personification

Explanation: Hyperbole — an exaggerated, emotionally emphatic claim. [medium, web-research]

4. "How did I get so lucky, you were the dad chosen for me?" is an example of:

A. Metaphor

B. Simile

C. Personification

D. Rhetorical question ✓

Explanation: A rhetorical question, asked for effect rather than a literal answer. [medium, web-research]

5. The repeated phrase "I just wanted you to know" is an example of:

A. Anaphora ✓

B. Epizeuxis

C. Anadiplosis

D. Chiasmus

Explanation: Anaphora — repetition at the start of successive lines. [hard, web-research]

6. "Our love is everlasting" is an example of:

A. Hyperbole ✓

B. Metaphor

C. Simile

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Hyperbole — an absolute, exaggerated claim. [medium, web-research]